

Argument

20 possible points (20%)

18

Assessment

Does the paper focus on one central question that ties the paper together? Is this thesis a relevant archaeological question that is supportable using the scholarly sources cited in the essay?

Use of Evidence

30 possible points (30%)

28

Assessment

Are at least three new sources referenced, and are the references chosen appropriate scientific sources? How closely are the multiple sources of evidence integrated analytically? Do these lines of evidence support the arguments presented by the author?

Quality of Thought

20 possible points (20%)

18

Assessment

Does the essay demonstrate a clear understanding of archaeological evidence and the data types and scientific methods chosen? Are meaningful comparisons between diverse sources of evidence explored? Does the essay demonstrate insight or an original perspective on the topic?

Organization

20 possible points (20%)

18

Assessment

Is the introduction focused around a clear thesis argument, with relevant background information and supporting arguments laid out in a logical and effective order, and a coherent conclusion?

Style

10 possible points (10%)

7

Assessment

Does the essay fulfill the requirements of the essay as specified in the assignment, including structure, length, citation use and style, bibliography, page numbers, and title? Do the language, syntax, grammar, and vocabulary of the paper fulfill expectations for analytical writing at the college level? Has the paper been adequately proofread and spell-checked?